

D708

Advanced Clinical in Elementary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A candidate preparing a performance assessment lesson for a third-grade class that loves animals writes several objectives. The class has a reading buddy program with fifth graders. Which objective is measurable?

- A. "Students will read with their fifth-grade buddies."
- B. "Students will appreciate animal stories."
- C. "Given an informational text about animals, students will identify the main idea and two supporting details with 80% accuracy."
- D. "Students will understand main idea."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A candidate's objective reads, "Students will know the parts of a plant." Which revision makes it measurable?

- A. "Students will label the roots, stem, leaves, and flower on a diagram with at least 3 of 4 correct."
- B. "Students will enjoy a plant video."
- C. "Students will really know the parts of a plant."
- D. "Students will learn about plants."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A candidate's objective is "Students will compare two versions of a fairy tale using a Venn diagram." The lesson includes a lively puppet show, and the class won the school's attendance award. Which assessment is aligned?

- A. Students perform a puppet show.
- B. Students list the characters in one version.
- C. Students define "fairy tale."
- D. Students complete a Venn diagram and write two sentences comparing the versions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Before a unit on multi-digit multiplication, a candidate gives a pre-assessment. Twelve of 24 students cannot yet multiply by multiples of ten, and six already solve two-digit by two-digit problems. The school recently repainted the hallways. How should she plan?

- A. Begin with multiples of ten for those who need it, provide extension for the six, and bring all toward the unit goal.
- B. Teach only the six advanced students.
- C. Skip the unit, since six students already know it.
- D. Start at the textbook's first lesson for everyone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

In a second-grade science lesson, which uses donated magnifying glasses, students must explain why some objects sink and others float. The class includes several English learners. What is the lesson's main language function, and a fitting support?

- A. None; science lessons have no language demands.
- B. Vocabulary; a word list of sink and float only.
- C. Describe; a frame like "I see ____."
- D. Explain; a sentence frame like "The ____ floats because ____."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A lesson asks students to write, "First, ... Next, ... Finally, ..." to retell the steps of an experiment. What language demand does this frame mainly support?

- A. Decoding
- B. Syntax and discourse, organizing a sequence
- C. The language function of arguing
- D. Vocabulary only

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A candidate teaching a fourth-grade lesson on regions of the United States, in a class that just finished a state history fair, has students who are advanced readers, on-level readers, and emerging readers. The goal is for all to describe a region's climate and economy. Which plan differentiates appropriately?

- A. Provide texts on the same region at different reading levels, with a shared organizer for climate and economy.
- B. Have emerging readers color a map instead of meeting the goal.
- C. Give advanced readers two extra worksheets.
- D. Repeat the history-fair projects.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Students may show what they learned about a habitat by writing a report, making a labeled diagram, or recording a short explanation. What is being differentiated?

- A. Process
- B. The learning goal
- C. Product
- D. Content

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

After a lesson on comparing fractions in a class of 20 whose teacher just won a grant, 14 students score 80% or higher, the criterion. Of the 6 who did not, 5 compared denominators only. What is the best summary and next step?

- A. 70% met; use the grant to buy new books.
- B. The class average was high, so move on.
- C. 30% met the criterion; reteach everyone.
- D. 70% met the criterion; reteach the 6 with fraction models focused on comparing both numerator and denominator.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A class of 25 has an 82% average on a quiz, but only 15 students met the 80% criterion. What should the candidate report?

- A.** 82% of students met the criterion.
- B.** 15% met the criterion.
- C.** Only 60% met the criterion, even though the average is 82%.
- D.** 40% met the criterion.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A candidate is writing a note to the family of a first grader who is behind in reading. The family recently moved into a new apartment and speaks Spanish at home. Which note is best?

- A.** A note saying the child must read only in English at home.
- B.** A note in Spanish that begins with a strength, explains the goal simply, suggests reading together 10 minutes a night in any language, and invites them to call with questions.
- C.** A note in English listing DIBELS scores and “Tier 2 intervention.”
- D.** A note asking about the new apartment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

After teaching three lessons for a performance assessment in a school with a new library, a candidate writes her commentary. Her mentor praised her energy. Which statement best shows evidence-based reflection?

- A.** “My mentor liked my energy, so the lessons worked.”
- B.** “Exit tickets show 9 of 22 students mixed up cause and effect; next time I will model with a graphic organizer, since explicit modeling supports text-structure learning.”
- C.** “The lessons went well and the students were engaged.”
- D.** “All students mastered the objective.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A candidate preparing a performance assessment lesson for a third-grade class ~~that loves animals~~ writes several objectives. ~~The class has a reading buddy program with fifth graders.~~ Which objective is measurable?

Target word: pick the measurable objective **Decides:** Observable verb plus criterion.

A	Camouflage	An activity, not a learning outcome.
B	Adjacent category	An attitude, not measurable learning.
C	Correct	Observable verb, condition, and criterion.
D	Dropped element	Understand is not observable; no criterion.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A candidate's objective reads, "Students will know the parts of a plant." Which revision makes it measurable?

Target word: fix the objective **Decides:** Replace know with an observable verb and add a criterion.

A	Correct	Observable action and a criterion.
B	Adjacent category	An activity and attitude, not an outcome.
C	Dropped element	Still not observable.
D	Confusion set	Learn is as unobservable as know.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A candidate's objective is "Students will compare two versions of a fairy tale using a Venn diagram." ~~The lesson includes a lively puppet show, and the class won the school's attendance award.~~ Which assessment is aligned?

Target word: aligned assessment **Decides:** The assessment must ask students to compare the two versions.

A	Camouflage	An engaging activity that does not measure comparing.
B	Dropped element	Drops the second version and the comparing.
C	Adjacent category	Recall, not the comparison skill.
D	Correct	Measures the same skill as the objective.

4. Answer A Concept 3

Before a unit on multi-digit multiplication, a candidate gives a pre-assessment. Twelve of 24 students cannot yet multiply by multiples of ten, and six already solve two-digit by two-digit problems. ~~The school recently repainted the hallways.~~ How should she plan?

Target word: planning decision **Decides:** The class is split; plan different starting points toward the goal.

A	Correct	Uses data to set different starting points.
B	Inverted operation	Ignores the group with the greatest need.
C	Absolute language	Most students still need the unit.
D	Dropped element	Drops the pre-assessment data.

5. Answer D Concept 4

In a second-grade science lesson, ~~which uses donated magnifying glasses~~, students must explain why some objects sink and others float. The class includes several English learners. What is the lesson's main language function, and a fitting support?

Target word: language function and support **Decides:** "Explain why" is the function.

A	Absolute language	Every lesson has language demands.
B	Adjacent category	Vocabulary is one demand, not the function.
C	Confusion set	Describing what is seen is not explaining why.
D	Correct	The function is explaining cause, and the frame supports it.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A lesson asks students to write, "First, ... Next, ... Finally, ..." to retell the steps of an experiment. What language demand does this frame mainly support?

Target word: which demand the support targets **Decides:** Sequence words structure the sentences (syntax/discourse).

A	Inverted operation	Decoding is reading words, not producing organized language.
B	Correct	The frame shapes how ideas are organized in writing.
C	Confusion set	Retelling steps is sequencing, not arguing.
D	Adjacent category	The frame gives structure, not content words.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A candidate teaching a fourth-grade lesson on regions of the United States, ~~in a class that just finished a state history fair~~, has students who are advanced readers, on-level readers, and emerging readers. The goal is for all to describe a region's climate and economy. Which plan differentiates appropriately?

Target word: appropriate differentiation **Decides:** Same goal, different text levels or supports.

A	Correct	Content differentiated by readiness; same goal for all.
B	Dropped element	Drops the learning goal.
C	Adjacent category	More of the same is not differentiation.
D	Camouflage	The fair does not address this goal.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

Students may show what they learned about a habitat by writing a report, making a labeled diagram, or recording a short explanation. What is being differentiated?

Target word: which element **Decides:** The way students show learning is the product.

A	Adjacent category	Process is how students make sense of content during learning.
B	Inverted operation	Differentiation keeps the goal the same.
C	Correct	Different ways to show the same learning.
D	Confusion set	The habitat content is the same for everyone.

9. Answer D Concept 6

After a lesson on comparing fractions in a class of 20 ~~whose teacher just won a grant~~, 14 students score 80% or higher, the criterion. Of the 6 who did not, 5 compared denominators only. What is the best summary and next step?

Target word: summary and next step **Decides:** $14 \div 20 = 70\%$ met; common error pattern.

A	Camouflage	The grant does not address the learning pattern.
B	Dropped element	Drops the students who did not meet the goal.
C	Inverted operation	30% is the share who did not meet it.
D	Correct	Uses the percent and the error pattern.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A class of 25 has an 82% average on a quiz, but only 15 students met the 80% criterion. What should the candidate report?

Target word: which statistic is accurate for the goal **Decides:** $15 \div 25 = 60\%$ met the criterion.

A	Confusion set	Confuses the average score with the share meeting the goal.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the count as a percent.
C	Correct	The average hides the 10 students who did not meet it.
D	Inverted operation	40% is the share who did not.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A candidate is writing a note to the family of a first grader who is behind in reading. The family ~~recently moved into a new apartment~~ and speaks Spanish at home. Which note is best?

Target word: best note **Decides:** Strengths first, plain language, a concrete home activity, two-way, in the family's language.

A	Absolute language	Reading in the home language also builds literacy.
B	Correct	Strengths-based, clear, actionable, and two-way.
C	Dropped element	Drops plain language, strengths, and the family's language.
D	Camouflage	Does not address the child's reading.

12. Answer B Concept 8

After teaching three lessons for a performance assessment ~~in a school with a new library~~, a candidate writes her commentary. ~~Her mentor praised her energy.~~ Which statement best shows evidence-based reflection?

Target word: best reflective statement **Decides:** A claim tied to student evidence and a research-based next step.

A	Camouflage	Praise for delivery is not evidence of learning.
B	Correct	Specific evidence plus a grounded next step.
C	Dropped element	No evidence or next step.
D	Absolute language	An unsupported absolute claim.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	8	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Measurable learning objectives	A usable objective names an observable behavior (identify, compare, write, solve), the condition, and a criterion; verbs like understand, know, or appreciate cannot be observed.	Writing “Students will understand...” as the objective.	The verb in an objective.
2	Alignment	Objective, learning activities, and assessment must target the same skill at the same level of thinking.	An engaging activity or test that measures something other than the objective.	An assessment that asks for a different skill than the objective.
3	Planning from pre-assessment and context	Use pre-assessment data and knowledge of students’ strengths, needs, and backgrounds to decide starting points and supports, not the textbook sequence alone.	Teaching the next page no matter what the pre-assessment shows.	Pre-assessment results that show a split in the class.
4	Academic language demands	Each lesson has a language function (e.g., compare, explain), vocabulary, and syntax or discourse demands; plan supports such as sentence frames and word banks.	Treating academic language as only a vocabulary list.	The key verb students must do with language.
5	Differentiation	Adjust content, process, or product according to student readiness, interest, or learning profile while keeping the same learning goal.	Differentiating by giving advanced students more of the same work, or lowering the goal for others.	Groups with different needs working toward one objective.
6	Analyzing assessment results	Summarize results against the criterion for the whole class and look for patterns by group and by error type to plan next steps.	Reporting only the class average, which hides who did not meet the goal.	A table of student scores after a lesson.
7	Communicating with families	Family communication should be two-way, jargon-free, specific, and open with strengths before concerns, with a concrete way families can help.	Sending test scores and education jargon with no strengths or next steps.	A note or conference about a student’s progress.
8	Evidence-based reflection	Strong reflection ties claims about learning to evidence from student work and proposes next steps grounded in research or theory.	General statements like “The lesson went well” with no evidence.	A written commentary after teaching.

Course scope (public description): Advanced Clinical provides aspiring educators with real-world classroom experience. This course emphasizes the importance of hands-on learning, offering candidates the unique opportunity to observe and participate in classroom environments under the guidance of experienced mentors. The curriculum includes demonstrating reflective practice, classroom engagement techniques, instructional strategies, and effective communication skills with students and colleagues through a pedagogical performance

assessment. Through this immersive experience, candidates not only observe the daily responsibilities of a teacher, but also start to develop their own teaching style and philosophy, laying a solid foundation for their future careers in education. This course is taken immediately prior to Student Teaching I as part of an engaging and intensive clinical experience.